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What role will AI play in India's future?

As the world enters an era defined by artificial intelligence (AI), India stands out as a land brimming with opportunities. With its robust digital infrastructure, remarkable engineering talent, and innovative spirit, India is uniquely positioned not only to adopt AI technologies but also to lead in their development and implementation.

According to a recent report by IDC and Intel, AI infrastructure spending is projected to reach \$733 million by 2027, with substantial investments expected in 2024 and 2025 to enhance infrastructure for high-impact use cases. The report indicates that, in the long term, AI spending will likely depend on the size of economies and populations, as these are primary drivers of data—a critical resource for AI applications. This underscores the potential for markets like India to emerge as future AI powerhouses, highlighting the necessity for ongoing investment and innovation in AI.

AI IS AMAZING INDIA

AI in India is not just about artificial intelligence; it embodies 'Amazing India.' Technology is deeply ingrained in the fabric of the nation, and every problem seemingly has a digital solution. India Stack has been a game changer, and no other nation has digital infrastructure on

the scale that India has. With 936 million internet subscribers¹, 1.1 billion mobile subscribers² (over 630 million using smartphones), and 400 million active social media users, India already boasts a highly connected population.

Initiatives like UPI, Jan Dhan Yojana, CoWIN, Aadhaar, DigiLocker, and ONDC are world-leading examples of digital solutions at scale. DigiLocker has more than 137 million users, UPI has 390 million active users³, and CoWIN has registered 1.1 billion individuals⁴. We do 11 times the transactions that US and Europe combined does in a day, reflecting the population scale of these innovations. We are just getting warmed up for the AI era!

FOSTERING TALENT FOR MAKING AI FOR THE WORLD

India is home to an exceptional talent pool. With the second-largest AI/ML/Big Data Analytics workforce globally and the top ranking in AI skill penetration, India boasts a highly skilled workforce ready to make solutions not just for India but also for the world. India's massive developer community, poised to surpass the US by 2027⁵, fuels innovation and further strengthens India's position in the AI race.

Driven by a large population and limited resources, India fosters a unique approach to AI innovation.



India generates 20% of the world's total data, which could act as a means to train India-centric AI models. However, with only 3% of the world's servers, much of this data currently resides outside the country. This presents a huge opportunity for India to develop its domestic AI infrastructure and fully unlock the potential of its data.

